

The fisherman's eyes sparkled. "With a second pole my son could fish with me."

"Exactly!" the tourist said. "You and your son would catch many more fish. After a while you could buy a second boat and hire fishermen to work it for you. Then you'd buy another boat and then another and another."

The tourist started to speak more rapidly, perspiration covering his face. "Pretty soon you'd have enough money to buy a modern, oceangoing fishing boat. Then you could buy a fleet of boats and a shop to repair them. Eventually you'll set up an air-conditioned office in town and run your business from a comfortable chair, with a secretary and batteries of accountants to help you. One day you'll be able to hire people to run the business for you."

The tourist was gasping for breath. "Don't you see?" he screamed. "In no time at all you'd have so much money you'd never have to work again."

"What would I do then?" the fisherman asked.

"Why, you could do anything you want! You could forget your troubles, head for a beautiful cove, and just go fishing. You could sit and relax and fish all afternoon!"

The fisherman shrugged. "That's what I do already," he said. He turned back to his line and continued fishing.

SIMPLIFY, SIMPLIFY

Bare-bones retirees spend somewhat less than \$50 a day. Wealthier very early retirees, if they have children, spend more than \$50 a day (you'll find out how much more in chapter 9). But the \$50-a-Day Rule is the basis for all very early retirement, and the basis of the \$50-a-Day Rule is to simplify your life. Your infrastructure should serve rather than complicate. If what you want to do is relax and fish, all you need is a fishing line. A large fishing fleet takes you away from your goal, not toward it. The idea is to fish, not race through the day in a frenzied struggle to keep the fleet in the water. The rule is: